LEARN · GRAMMAR

A2

Used To (Past Habits)



'Used to' + base verb describes a repeated action or state in the past that isn't true anymore — it always signals a contrast with the present.

THE -D ONLY SHOWS UP ONCE

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE / QUESTION
used to + base verb	**use to (no -d)**
I used to play the guitar.	*Did you use to live here?*

didn't already carries the past

✗ Did you used to live here?

✓ Did you use to live here?

no present form — for a habit NOW, use present simple instead

a CURRENT habit: not "I use to play tennis" — just "I play tennis"

1 Form

Positive: **used to + base verb**. Negative: **didn't use to + base verb** (no -d on 'use'). Question: **Did + subject + use to + base verb?** (no -d on 'use').

- I **used to play** the guitar.
- She **didn't use to like** vegetables.
- **Did you use to live** here?

2 Meaning: a finished past habit or state

Something that happened repeatedly, or was true, over a period in the past — and is now different. Not for a single, one-time past action: use past simple for that.

- I **used to visit** my grandmother every summer. (repeated, now stopped)
- I **visited** my grandmother last summer. (one visit — past simple)
- This street **used to be** full of shops.

3 No present form

For a habit you have now, use present simple: I **play** tennis every weekend. Don't confuse 'used to' with 'be used to' / 'get used to', which mean something feels familiar: I **am used to** waking up early now.

4 Common mistakes

✗ I didn't used to like coffee.	✓ **I didn't use to like coffee.**	no -d after 'use' in the negative
✗ I use to play tennis every weekend.	✓ **I used to play tennis every weekend.**	positive statements need 'used to'
✗ I used to went to school by bus.	✓ **I used to go to school by bus.**	'used to' + base verb

APPLY · PRACTICE

A2

Used To Practice

A Choose the correct word

1. I ___ play the guitar when I was a teenager. **(used to / use to / uses to)**
2. Did you ___ live in Italy? **(used to / use to / uses to)**
3. She ___ have long hair, but she cut it short. **(used to / use to / is used to)**
4. We ___ eat meat, but now we're vegetarian. **(didn't used to / didn't use to / don't used to)**
5. ___ you use to walk to school? **(Did / Do / Were)**
6. What ___ you use to do on Sundays? **(did / do / were)**

B Complete with the verb in brackets

1. I ___ (use) to hate vegetables, but now I love them.
2. She didn't ___ (use) to drink coffee.
3. We ___ (use) to go camping every summer.
4. He ___ (not / use) to eat meat, but he does now.
5. This building ___ (use) to be a cinema.
6. My sister and I ___ (use) to share a bedroom.

C Find and fix the mistake

1. We didn't use to liked spicy food.
2. He didn't use to enjoyed cooking.
3. My brother used to has a motorbike.
4. She used to eating breakfast at 6am.
5. Did we used to have a cat?
6. My aunt used to sang in a choir.

D Make it negative, then a question

1. she / have / really long hair
   NEGATIVE **QUESTION**
2. we / live / in a tiny apartment downtown
   NEGATIVE **QUESTION**
3. my grandparents / grow / their own vegetables
   NEGATIVE **QUESTION**
4. he / work / at that restaurant
   NEGATIVE **QUESTION**

E Speak

say it out loud with a partner

1. Ask a partner 'Did you use to...?' about their childhood.
2. Use 'used to be' to describe how a place has changed over time.